

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel Subject Matter Expert | Detection Engineering Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) with over five years of progressive experience as a senior cyber security engineer, specialising in Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) platform engineering, detection content development, and security monitoring architecture. I have deep, hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel, building and optimising analytics rules, correlation logic, threat-hunting queries, and reusable detection content aligned with the MITRE ATT&CK framework. I am proficient in Kusto Query Language (KQL) for detection-as-code, data connector engineering, and logging pipeline management across Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR), Microsoft Entra Identity Detection and Response (MDI), Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), and the wider Microsoft Security portfolio. I am passionate about driving measurable improvements to enterprise monitoring and cyber resilience through rigorous platform engineering, telemetry optimisation, and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) automation.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platform Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL, analytics rules, workbooks, data connectors, Data Collection Rules, custom tables, API-based integrations, Log Analytics), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), LogScale
- **Detection Engineering and Content Development:** Analytics rule design, correlation logic, threat-hunting query development, detection-as-code methodologies, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection content, alert tuning and validation
- **Microsoft Security Portfolio:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender XDR, Microsoft Entra Identity Detection and Response, Intune MDM/Mobile Application Management (MAM), Microsoft Purview
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, NG-SIEM), Microsoft Defender XDR, 8,000-user enterprise deployment
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), PowerShell scripting, API integrations
- **Security Operations and Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident response lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, threat hunting, alert triage, Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, penetration testing remediation
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management (PIM)
- **Security Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK
- **Additional Tools:** Check Point Harmony, Mimecast, Tanium, Splunk (SPL), Microsoft Intune, CrowdStrike Falcon Insight

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Serve as Subject Matter Expert for Microsoft Sentinel, designing and deploying analytics rules, correlation logic, and threat-hunting queries aligned with the MITRE ATT&CK framework to improve enterprise detection coverage and effectiveness.
- Engineer and optimise Microsoft Sentinel data connectors, Data Collection Rules (DCRs), custom parsers, custom tables, and API-based integrations to ensure high-quality telemetry ingestion across 8,000-user Microsoft 365 and hybrid cloud environments.

- Develop detection-as-code content and KQL-based analytics to detect sophisticated threats including lateral movement, credential theft, privilege escalation, and data exfiltration.
- Lead SOAR automation initiatives using Microsoft Sentinel playbooks and Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond to security incidents by automating alert enrichment, triage, and containment workflows.
- Architect and maintain the CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM environment, configuring detection policies, endpoint prevention rules, and Falcon Insight threat-hunting capabilities.
- Lead security incident response using the NIST 800-61 framework, performing forensic analysis, threat containment, eradication, and post-incident reviews with detailed documentation.
- Manage the Microsoft Defender XDR suite (Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, Defender for Office 365) across the enterprise, reducing attack surface and improving incident response efficiency.
- Conduct threat hunting operations using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel, proactively identifying indicators of compromise and previously undetected adversary activity.
- Contribute to security monitoring architecture decisions, ensuring logging pipeline quality, data coverage, and detection fidelity across on-premises and Microsoft Azure cloud environments.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) | Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and managed Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, building detection rules, KQL threat-hunting queries, and automated response playbooks to improve SOC efficiency.
- Administered Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO configurations, strengthening identity security across the organisation.
- Conducted vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Nessus, and AppCheck; triaged findings and collaborated with IT teams to prioritise and track remediation across the infrastructure.
- Performed alert triage and investigation on the 24/7 security monitoring platform, ensuring all events were documented and escalated in accordance with established playbooks.
- Managed BeyondTrust PAM solution to enforce least-privilege access controls and monitor privileged account activity.
- Supported the onboarding and configuration of CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across the enterprise endpoint estate, improving endpoint detection and prevention capabilities.
- Participated in red team/blue team exercises using Pentera BAS, identifying detection gaps and improving analytics rule coverage in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Maintained compliance alignment with ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, NIST CSF, and CIS Controls, producing audit evidence and contributing to risk assessments.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech) | IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls across the SaaS infrastructure, including network segmentation, firewall policy management (Check Point Harmony), and endpoint security tooling.
- Configured and managed Mimecast email security to reduce phishing and malware delivery risk; performed regular log review and threat investigation.
- Conducted risk assessments and vulnerability scans, tracking remediation activities and reporting findings to management.
- Supported identity and access management using Azure Active Directory, managing MFA, SSO, and Conditional Access policies for cloud-based SaaS applications.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities and internal security audits, producing documentation and evidence for annual certification reviews.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Reduced mean time to detect and respond to security incidents by deploying automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, significantly improving analyst efficiency and response consistency.
- Led the enterprise-wide deployment of Microsoft Defender XDR across an 8,000-user environment, achieving comprehensive endpoint, identity, and email threat detection coverage.
- Designed and deployed a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, improving coverage across all major attack tactics and eliminating critical detection blind spots.

- Architected and optimised CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM ingestion pipelines, ensuring high-fidelity telemetry and reducing false-positive rates through systematic rule tuning.
- Established a formal threat-hunting programme using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, proactively identifying advanced persistent threats and reducing dwell time.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification by implementing and documenting all required technical controls across the organisation's IT environment.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)